MCCD Saida 2027
Mediterranean Capital of Culture & Dialogue

Your new website: *what we need from you*

The website for Saida's 2027 programme is built and working. To open it to the public, we need some information, files and decisions that only your team can provide.

> **You do not need any technical knowledge to use this guide.** Each item explains what it is, why we need it, and exactly what to send. Most answers are a few sentences, a file, or a simple yes or no.
>
> Tick each box as you go, and send things whenever they are ready. You do not have to send everything at once.

Prepared October 2026 · Website preview available in English and Arabic

START HERE

How to use this guide

Labels you will see

Needed before launch

The website cannot go public without it.

Your decision

We just need your choice. Options are explained.

Can come later

Nice to have. The website works without it.

How to send things

Email is fine for everything. For photos and logos, a shared folder (Google Drive, Dropbox or OneDrive) works best because email makes photos smaller.

In your email, mention the **item number** from this guide, for example “Item 8: events”.

Everything at a glance

#	WHAT WE NEED	TYPE	DONE
1	Official contact email addresses	Before launch	☐
2	Official name of the organising committee	Before launch	☐
3	Confirm the partners and their roles	Before launch	☐
4	Should the Ministry of Foreign Affairs appear?	Decision	☐
5	Official logo files and permission to use them	Before launch	☐
6	Social media accounts	Later	☐
7	Venue details	Before launch	☐
8	The real events	Before launch	☐
9	News articles	Before launch	☐
10	Main photo for the home page	Recommended	☐
11	Photos for events and news	Recommended	☐
12	Photo permissions and credits	With the photos	☐
13	Rules for booking a venue	Before launch	☐
14	Who reviews event submissions	Before launch	☐
15	Privacy: who is responsible for personal information	Before launch	☐
16	Read and approve the website text (English and Arabic)	Before launch	☐
17	The website address (domain)	Before launch	☐
18	Interactive map account	Later	☐
19	Who looks after the website after launch	Before launch	☐
20	Final approval to go live	Last step	☐

PART 1

Who you are

Names, contacts and logos. These appear on every page of the website, so they need to be exactly right.

1 Official contact email addresses

Needed before launch

Why The website currently says "Official email to be confirmed" at the bottom of every page and on the Contact page. Visitors need a way to reach the team.

Please send:

- The **public email** shown to visitors.
- The email that should **receive messages** sent through the website's contact form (it can be the same one).
- The email that should **receive event proposals** from organisers (it can be the same one).

Example: info@saida2027.lb for all three.

☐ Sent

2 Official name of the organising committee

Needed before launch

Why The "About" page currently says "MCCD Saida 2027 organising committee — official name to be confirmed".

Please send: the committee's official name, written exactly as it should appear, **in English and in Arabic**.

☐ Sent

3 Confirm the partners and their roles

Needed before launch

Why The "About" page shows who is behind the programme, in three groups. Please check that this is correct.

GROUP ON THE WEBSITE	WHO IS SHOWN NOW
Regional coordinators	Union for the Mediterranean (UfM) and Anna Lindh Foundation (ALF)
Host city	Saida, Lebanon (with the municipality crest)
Local delivery	Saida Municipality and the organising committee

Please send: "Correct as shown", or tell us what to add, remove or rename.

☐ Correct as shown ☐ Changes sent

4 Should the Ministry of Foreign Affairs appear?

Your decision

Why We were asked to check this with you. It is not on the website at the moment.

Please tell us: Yes or No. If yes, which group it belongs to (see item 3), and please include its approved logo with item 5.

☐ Yes ☐ No

5 Official logo files and permission to use them

Needed before launch

Why To show the website, we temporarily copied the UfM and Anna Lindh Foundation logos from their public websites. Before launch, each organisation should provide its official logo and approve how it is used.

Please send:

- Official logos for **UfM** and **Anna Lindh Foundation**, and the Ministry if you said yes in item 4.
- Any **rules** each organisation has for its logo (size, colours, space around it).
- A **high-quality version of the Saida crest**, ideally with a transparent background. The current version has a white background.

Tip: ask each organisation's communications team for "the logo pack". The best files end in .svg or .png. Please do not send logos taken from screenshots.

☐ UfM ☐ ALF ☐ Ministry (if needed) ☐ Saida crest

6 Social media accounts

Can come later

Why We can add links to your social media at the bottom of every page.

Please send: the full link for each account you want to show, such as Instagram, Facebook, X, YouTube or LinkedIn. If there are no accounts yet, just tell us.

Example: https://www.instagram.com/saida2027

☐ Sent ☐ No accounts

PART 2

Places, events and news

Everything you see on the website now (9 events and 3 news articles) is sample content written to show how the website works. It needs to be replaced with the real programme.

7 Venue details

Needed before launch

Why Each event page shows its venue on a map and lists its accessibility information. The map pins are approximate at the moment.

The website currently has **four venues**: Sea Castle esplanade · Khan al-Franj · Debbaneh Palace · Old City / Bab al-Saray Square.

For each venue (including any new ones), please send:

- The name **in English and in Arabic**.
- The **exact location**: open Google Maps, press and hold on the entrance, and send us the link or the numbers that appear.
- **Accessibility**: Is there step-free access? Accessible toilets? Seating? Parking nearby? Anything visitors should know?
- **Opening hours** and **how many people** it can hold (this is also needed for item 13).

☐ Sea Castle ☐ Khan al-Franj ☐ Debbaneh Palace ☐ Old City ☐ New venues

8 The real events

Needed before launch

Why The programme page and the calendar are the heart of the website.

Please send: the details for each event using the **event form at the end of this guide**. Fill one form per event, or send the same information in an email or a spreadsheet, whichever is easiest.

You can start with the confirmed events. More can be added at any time, including after launch.

☐ First events sent

9 News articles

Needed before launch

Why The home page shows the three latest news articles. At least one real article is needed for launch, for example an announcement of the programme.

For each article, please send:

- The **title** and the **text**, in English and in Arabic.
- The **date** it should be published.
- The **type**: Announcement, Programme update, or Community.
- A **photo**, if you have one (see Part 3).

☐ First article sent

PART 3

Photos

Where photos belong, the website currently shows drawn illustrations. As soon as you send photos, they replace the drawings automatically. If an event has no photo, the drawing simply stays.

What makes a good website photo

- Send the **original file** from the camera or phone. Photos sent over WhatsApp or pasted into documents lose quality.
- Large: at least **1600 pixels wide**. Most photos from a modern phone are fine.
- Bright, sharp, and **without text or logos** placed on top.
- Keep the main subject **near the centre**. The website crops photos to fit different shapes.

10 Main photo for the home page

Recommended

Why The large image at the top of the home page is the first thing every visitor sees. It currently shows a drawing with the caption “Photography to be confirmed”.

Please send: one strong photo that represents Saida and the sea. Upright (portrait) photos work best for this space.

☐ Sent

11 Photos for events and news

Recommended

Why Each event page and each news article has space for one main photo.

Please send: one photo per event or article. Name each file after the event so we know where it goes.

Example file name: evening-by-the-sea.jpg

☐ Sent

12 Photo permissions and credits

Needed with the photos

Why Publishing a photo without the photographer's permission can cause legal problems. If people can be clearly recognised, they should have agreed to appear.

For each photo, please confirm:

- You have **permission** to use it on the website.
- The **photographer's name**, if they should be credited.

Optional: *a one-sentence description of each photo, for visitors who are blind and use screen readers, for example "Fishing boats in Saida harbour at sunset". If you don't send one, the website uses the event or article title instead.*

☐ Permissions confirmed

PART 4

When organisers propose events

The website lets local organisers propose an event: they describe it, choose a venue, pick a date and time, and leave their contact details. We need your rules for this.

13 Rules for booking a venue

Needed before launch

Why The website only shows dates and times that are actually available, so it needs to know your rules. The current hours are only placeholders.

How should a venue be booked? Your decision

- ☐ **In time slots** (as now): Morning 09:00–12:00 · Afternoon 14:00–17:00 · Evening 18:00–21:00. Up to three events per venue per day. Tell us if these times should change.
- ☐ **A whole day at a time**: one event per venue per day.

Please also send:

- **Which venues** organisers may book (all of them, or only some).
- Any dates when venues are **closed or unavailable** (holidays, maintenance, events already planned by you).
- The **maximum number of people** allowed at each venue, if there is one.

☐ Decided and sent

14 Who reviews event submissions

Needed before launch

Why When an organiser submits an event, someone from your team needs to read it and decide.

When should a submitted event appear on the public programme? Your decision

- ☐ **Only after your team approves it.** This is safer: nothing appears without a check.
- ☐ **Immediately**, with your team able to remove it afterwards.

Please also send:

- The **name and email** of the person, or people, who will review submissions.
- How submissions in **only one language** should be handled. Organisers may write only in Arabic or only in English. Who will translate them before publishing?

☐ Decided and sent

PART 5

Privacy and personal information

The website collects names, emails and phone numbers from organisers and from people using the contact form. The law requires the website to say who is responsible for this information and how it is handled.

15 Who is responsible for personal information

Needed before launch

Why The Privacy page currently says these details "must be confirmed and added here". We recommend checking your answers with your legal advisor.

Please send:

- **Who is legally responsible** for the information collected. This is usually an organisation, for example Saida Municipality.
- An **email address** people can write to if they want to see, correct or delete their information.
- **How long** the information should be kept. Example: "12 months after the event, then deleted".
- **Who in your team** is allowed to see organisers' phone numbers and emails.

☐ Sent

PART 6

Checking the words

Every word on the website should be approved by your team before the public sees it.

16 Read and approve the website text

Needed before launch

Why We wrote all the text on the website in English and Arabic, but it has not yet been approved by your team. This includes the accessibility statement and the information for organisers.

Please: open the preview link we send you, read each page **in both languages**, and send corrections. A screenshot with a note, or a simple list such as "About page, second paragraph: change X to Y", is perfect.

PAGE	ENGLISH	ARABIC
Home	☐	☐
Programme (events list and calendar)	☐	☐
About	☐	☐
News	☐	☐
Submit an event (all 4 steps)	☐	☐
Contact	☐	☐
Privacy	☐	☐
Accessibility	☐	☐

PART 7

Going live

The last practical steps before the public can visit the website.

17 The website address (domain)

Needed before launch

What it is The address people type to visit the website, for example *www.saida2027.lb*. It is registered for a small yearly fee.

Please tell us:

- Which **address** you would like, or the one you already own.
- **Who will register and own it**. We recommend the Municipality or the committee owns it in its own name, so you always keep control.

☐ Address chosen ☐ Owner confirmed

18 Interactive map account

Can come later

What it is Each event page has a small map of the venue. To show a real, zoomable map, the website uses a map service called Mapbox, which needs an account. It is free at the expected number of visitors. Without it, a simple drawn map is shown.

Please choose: create a free Mapbox account yourselves and we will tell you exactly what to copy and send us, or allow us to create it on your behalf.

☐ We will create it ☐ Please create it for us ☐ Not needed

19 Who looks after the website after launch

Needed before launch

Why Once the website is live, someone needs to add new events and news, answer messages, and be our contact for any problems.

Please send:

- The **name, role and email** of the main person responsible for the website.
- Who should **own the website accounts** (the hosting service that keeps the site online). We recommend the same owner as the domain in item 17.

☐ Sent

20 Final approval to go live

Last step

Why When everything above is in place, we will send you the finished website to check one last time. It goes public only after your written approval.

Please send: a short email confirming “Approved for launch”, from someone authorised to approve.

☐ Approved

What happens next

1. **You send the items**
   In any order, whenever they are ready. Start with the ones marked “Needed before launch”.

2. **We add them to the website**
   We replace the samples with your real content, photos and details.

3. **You check the preview**
   We send you a private link to review everything in English and Arabic.

4. **The website goes live**
   After your final approval (item 20), the website opens to the public at your chosen address.

FORM · ITEM 8

Event information form

Copy this page once for each event. Leave a box empty if you don't know yet. We will mark it "to be confirmed" on the website.

Event name (English)	
Event name (Arabic)	
Description (English) 2–4 sentences	
Description (Arabic) 2–4 sentences	
Date	
Start time and end time	
Venue	
Type of event tick one	☐ Music & performance ☐ Heritage & walks ☐ Workshops ☐ Talks & dialogue ☐ Art & exhibitions
Who is it for? tick any	☐ Everyone ☐ Families ☐ Young people ☐ Adults
Language(s) spoken	☐ Arabic ☐ English ☐ French ☐ Other: _____
Entry	☐ Free ☐ Ticket needed. Ticket link: _____
Organiser (name shown publicly)	
Accessibility step-free access, seating, toilets, sign language, etc.	
Photo see Part 3	☐ Attached. File name: _____ ☐ No photo yet